conservation movement, forced legislative change, and, perhaps most significantly, championed the right of the public to question those in power and hold them to account.

However, the author of this ground-breaking work was far from the typical “eco-warrior”—a term that was unheard of when the book was first published. On the contrary, Rachel Carson was a quiet, scholarly woman, with a masters degree in zoology and 20 years’ service as an aquatic biologist in the United States. Most of all, she was an exceptional writer, able to fuse scientific fact with compelling narrative.